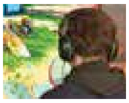
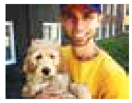


Welsh gamer loses accent
A gaming addict from Wales lost his accent as he was only interacting with other gamers online
https://dgit.in/sep18-80-1



Fur-ternity leave
New pet owners working at the digital marketing agency Nina Hale, can opt for a Fur-ternity leave
https://dgit.in/sep18-80-2

then proceeding to beat the stuffing out of it, and then claiming to have bested them in a fight.

This is the most common type of argument used by fanboys when arguing on two different sides of a tech debate. For example, you could say, "I love using WhatsApp and staying in touch with my school friends", to which someone could respond, "But Facebook owns WhatsApp and is used for fake news. So you're OK supporting a company that spreads fake news? I'm not, that's why I use Telegram."

HALO EFFECT

When one trait of a person or thing is used to make an overall judgment of that person or thing. For technology, this is usually a case of perception; for example, a company might leverage its expertise in one field to falsely claim expertise in another. Sometimes this is not something a company does, it's something users do all on their own. Fanboyism in any form is usually caused by the halo effect, and these days, we've got fanboyism pretty much everywhere!

A classic example was the success of the iPod boosting sales of Macs and other Apple products. Because the iPod was considered "cool" suddenly the general public thought (and to a large extent, still do think) that all Apple products were cool. To be clear, we're not saying that Apple products aren't good, because they obviously are, and are perfect for a lot of people... however, unless a user has truly weighed pros and cons of products available, and has informed himself/herself about other brands, they really are just falling for the Halo effect.

CAUSAL FALLACY (SLIPPERY SLOPE, POST HOC, ETC)

Usually, a slippery slope is a fallacy that's used negatively, while a causal fallacy is something that can be both positive or negative. The fallacy here is to draw conclusions from one event and wildly extrapolate them to a different event.

Slippery slope: This is where a small incident or even hypothetical scenario is then followed by more hypothetical scenarios, and the fallacy is completed when extrapolated to some extreme scenario. "If you buy an Chinese-made phone, China gets richer, they pollute the environment more, global warming occurs, and then we have acid rain in India!".

Post hoc ergo propter hoc: Just post hoc fallacy for short, this literally translates from Latin to "after this, thus because of this". The fallacy here is to equate an event as the cause of something else. This can be used both negatively and positively, and is more often than not used positively in marketing by companies. For example, adventurous men doing all sorts of extreme sports and then drinking a soft drink before or after their shenanigans is a subtle way of using the post hoc fallacy to equate an adventurous spirit with their product.

Cum hoc ergo propter hoc: This translates to "with this thus because of this". The idea here is to find two things that occur together, and then use that to assume causation. This is often used a lot to misrepresent a bogus position as scientific, or to just create links that are tenuous at best. An example would be, "95% of school toppers who own a smartphone, have Android phones" (This isn't true, we just made that up) The fallacy here is to slyly propose that the Android OS has anything to do with intelligence. (It doesn't, and neither does Apple. Relating any OS to intelligence is a fallacy.)

Editor's note: *We are going to use some of these causal fallacies for fun, in order to draw insane conclusions from a silly survey you will find on our Facebook page (Digit as well as Digit Geek pages). So remember to take the Digit WTF Survey.*

APPEAL TO AUTHORITY

This one is pretty simple, it suggests that a person of repute or respect should be listened to without a demand for evidence. Now, usually, it's actually a good idea to cite authorities when arguing, but to do so without presenting their evidence, or to do so by presenting an authority that has nothing to do with the field, or even to present people of questionable authority... are all examples of the appeal to authority fallacy.

An extremely common example is "9 out of 10 dentists agree that..." when advertising a toothpaste. Now, given that this is a tactic used by more than one toothpaste brand, it's easy to tell that everyone is lying. Yet it is an appeal to authority to get a dentist to recommend a toothpaste. The same for medications and doctors, and so on.

Then there's the completely disjointed authority – a film star advertising a water purifier. This is fine, and there's nothing wrong with it, but people should understand that film stars are just as ignorant about the techniques of water purification as we are, and are just reading lines fed to them. This goes for all products, and all product categories.

This can even be used to falsely advertise by using actual authorities. For example, you could use a Formula 1 designer to talk about the technology in a road car by the same brand. Sure, they're experts in the field, but they're hardly what you would call an unbiased source. Is it possible their claims are true? Sure, but isn't it better to just get your information from a truly unbiased source? For technology, that would be people like us at Digit, because we honestly don't care if Apple or Samsung wins the best phone of the year title, because either way we get to review both, and we can only be of use to you readers (our customers) if we remain totally unbiased.

TU QUOQUE

Translating to "you too", this fallacy basically focuses on hypocrisy, and ignores the point being made. So for example if a fat person were to say "exercise is good for health and controls weight", a tu quoque fallacy would be to respond to that by saying, "Well you're fat, so you are a hypocrite and shouldn't opine on this matter". Of course the person is fat and does not